Lesson 23

Self-Esteem, Low

"The Spirit of God has made me; the breath
of the Almighty gives me life."
(Job 33:4)

Self-Esteem: the appraised value or worth of oneself

Despite biblical evidence to the contrary, many Christians have extremely low self-esteem. They have listened to the lies that the world has taught them, and believe they are dumb, ugly, unimportant, worthless, etc. The Bible paints an entirely different view of Christians.

As Christians, it is important to realize that we are extremely valuable in God's eyes. Understanding who you are in Christ can be critically important to a mentally healthy life. The following is a partial list of scriptures that relate to your value and worth in the sight of God.

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WHO I AM…

I AM A CHILD OF GOD

You are all sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus.
(Galatians 3:26)

Yet to all who received him [Jesus Christ], to those who believed in his name, he gave the right to become children of God.
(John 1:12)

And by him we cry, "Abba, Father." The Spirit testifies with our spirit that we are God's children.
(Romans 8:15-16)

I AM MADE IN GOD'S IMAGE

So God created man in his own image, in the image of God he created him; male and female he created them.
(Genesis 1:27)

I AM GOD'S TEMPLE

Don't you know that you yourselves are God's temple and that God's Spirit lives in you?
(1 Corinthians 3:16)

I AM A WONDERFUL HAND-MADE CREATION OF GOD

For you created my inmost being; you knit me together in my mother's womb.
(Psalm 139:13)

I praise you because I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
(Psalm 139:14)

GOD CREATED ME "A LITTLE LOWER THAN THE HEAVENLY BEINGS"

You made him [man] a little lower than the heavenly beings and crowned him with glory and honor.
(Psalm 8:5)

I AM CHRIST'S AMBASSADOR ON EARTH

We are therefore Christ's ambassadors, as though God were making his appeal through us.
(2 Corinthians 5:20)

As God's fellow workers, we urge you not to receive God's grace in vain.
(2 Corinthians 6:1)

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I AM A CITIZEN OF HEAVEN

But our citizenship is in heaven. And we
eagerly await a Savior from there,
the Lord Jesus Christ.
(Philippians 3:20)

I AM A NEW CREATION IN CHRIST

Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new
creation; the old has gone, the new has come!
(2 Corinthians 5:17)

I AM BEING TRANSFORMED INTO CHRIST'S LIKENESS

And we, who with unveiled faces all reflect the Lord's glory,
are being transformed into his likeness with ever-increasing
glory, which comes from the Lord, who is the Spirit.
(2 Corinthians 3:18)

And just as we have borne the likeness of the earthly man,
so shall we bear the likeness of the man from heaven.
(1 Corinthians 15:49)

In this way, love is made complete among us so that
we will have confidence on the day of judgment,
because in this world we are like him.
(1 John 4:17)

I AM GOD'S WORKMANSHIP

For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus
to do good works, which God prepared
in advance for us to do.
(Ephesians 2:10)

I AM CHRIST'S FRIEND

*I no longer call you servants…Instead, I have called
you friends, for everything that I learned from
my Father I have made known to you.*
(John 15:15)

I HAVE BEEN CHOSEN BY GOD

*You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you to go
and bear fruit—fruit that will last. Then the father will give
you whatever you ask in my name.*
(John 15:16)

He appointed us, set his seal of ownership on us,
and put his Spirit in our hearts as a deposit,
guaranteeing what is to come.
(2 Corinthians 1:21-22)

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I AM A SAINT

Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God,
To the saints in Ephesus, the
faithful in Christ Jesus.
(Ephesians 1:1)

I AM A MEMBER OF CHRIST'S BODY

Now you are the body of Christ, and
each one of you is a part of it.
(1 Corinthians 12:27)

I am the vine; you are the branches. If a man remains in me and I in him, he will bear much fruit.
(John 15:5)

GOD LISTENS TO MY PRAYERS

This is the confidence we have in approaching God:
that if we ask anything according to his will,
he hears us.
(1 John 5:14)

I tell you the truth, my Father will give you whatever you ask in my name.
(John 16:23)

I AM AN HEIR TO THE KINGDOM OF GOD

Now if we are children, then we are heirs—heirs of God
and co-heirs with Christ, if indeed we share
in his sufferings in order that we
may also share in his glory.
(Romans 8:17)

Having believed, you were marked in him with a seal,
the promised Holy Spirit, who is a deposit guaranteeing
our inheritance until the redemption of those who are
God's possession—to the praise of his glory.
(Ephesians 1:13-14)

I AM STRONG IN CHRIST

I can do everything through him [Christ]
who gives me strength.
(Philippians 4:13)

CHRIST DIED FOR ME

But God demonstrates his own love for us
in this: While we were still sinners,
Christ died for us.
(Romans 5:8)

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MY SINS ARE FORGIVEN

Blessed is the man whose sin the Lord will
never count against him.
(Romans 4:8)

So if the Son sets you free [from sin],
you will be free indeed.
(John 8:36)

I AM FREE OF CONDEMNATION

Therefore, there is now no condemnation
for those who are in Christ Jesus.
(Romans 8:1)

THE HOLY SPIRIT LIVES IN ME

God has poured out his love into our hearts
by the Holy Spirit,
whom he has given us.
(Romans 5:5)

The Spirit gives life; the flesh counts for nothing.
(John 6:63)

BECAUSE OF CHRIST'S SACRIFICE, I AM RIGHTEOUS, BLAMELESS, AND HOLY BEFORE GOD

Christ is the end of the law so that there may be righteousness for everyone who believes.
(Romans 10:4)

But if Christ is in you, your body is dead because of sin, yet your spirit is alive because of righteousness.
(Romans 8:10)

But now that you have been set free from sin and have become slaves to God, the benefit you reap leads to holiness, and the result is eternal life.
(Romans 6:22)

For he chose us in him before the creation of the world to be holy and blameless in his sight.
(Ephesians 1:4)

GOD LOVES ME

For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life.
(John 3:16)

This is love: not that we loved God, but the he loved us and sent his Son as an atoning sacrifice for our sins.
(1 John 4:10)

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I CANNOT BE SEPARATED FROM GOD'S LOVE

For I am convinced that neither death nor life,
neither angels nor demons, neither the present
nor the future, nor any powers, neither height
nor depth, nor anything else in all creation,
will be able to separate us from the love of
God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord.
(Romans 8:38-39)